MAI MOHAMED HELMY

ART & DESIGN TEACHER CANDIDATE | CREATIVE WORKSHOP FACILITATOR | VISUAL ARTIST

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Professional Profile

Fine Arts graduate, exhibiting visual artist and creative facilitator with 28 years of professional art practice (since 1998) and more than four years of art-based work with children, young people and families (since 2022). Independently plans and leads structured individual and group activities, using step-by-step demonstrations, age-appropriate differentiation and individual progress reviews. Experienced supporting learners with ADHD, autism and diverse emotional or developmental needs in multidisciplinary and child-protection settings. Brings extensive expertise in painting, drawing, printmaking and mixed media to inclusive Art & Design education.

Strengths for the Art Classroom

Creative instruction | Lesson-activity sequencing | Adapted materials | Positive behaviour support | Visual instructions | Learner-centred assessment | SEND-informed participation | Child wellbeing and safeguarding awareness

Teaching-Relevant Professional Experience

Independent Art-Based Workshop Facilitator & Art Therapy Practitioner — 2022–Present

Independent practice | Cairo

- Plan and lead individual and group creative workshops for children, adolescents and families, defining objectives, selecting materials, demonstrating techniques and reviewing progress.
- Adapt activities to different attention spans, artistic abilities and sensory preferences using simplified instructions, alternative media, achievable stages and encouragement.

Art & Behaviour Support Practitioner / Workshop Facilitator — 2022–2024

Al-Dar Center for Psychological Support | Cairo

- Independently designed, delivered and supervised art-based sessions for children, including those with ADHD, autism and participation or concentration challenges.
- Prepared individual support plans in consultation with specialists; reviewed each child's development through successive artworks rather than comparisons with peers.
- Worked with families and specialist teams; contributed to increased demand for the centre's art-based workshops and sessions.

Children's Creative Workshop Facilitator & Family Support — 2024 (6 months)

Child Protection Centre, Egyptian Association for Community Building and Protection of Children from Violence | UNICEF-partner programme

- Led paid creative group activities supporting self-expression, safety and participation among children affected by violence, displacement and adversity.
- Received training in child-protection case-study documentation and programme electronic reporting forms; supported families in a multidisciplinary setting.

Student & Community Art Workshop Facilitator — 2022; 2025

British University in Egypt (BUE) and Arab Academy (AAST), 2022 | Children's Cancer Hospital Egypt 57357, 2025

- Facilitated emotion-expression art workshops for university students and age-appropriate creative activities for children aged approximately 6–16 at Hospital 57357, using colour and choice to encourage confidence and expression.

Professional Visual Artist & Printmaker — 1998–Present

Independent studio practice | Egypt and international exhibitions

- Maintain a professional practice across painting, drawing, relief and intaglio printmaking, screen printing, lithography and mixed media; awarded Egypt's State Grant for Artistic Dedication for four consecutive years.

Selected Workshops & Learner-Centred Practice

Attention and focus through clay pattern-making **Ages 7–10**
Structured, progressively challenging art activity

Designed exercises in which children arranged small pieces of clay into ordered patterns, with more complex clay-coiling variations for older or more confident learners.

Water marbling for creative and emotional expression **Ages 15–20**
Exploration, interpretation and reflection

Led image-making on water followed by discussion of unexpected shapes and personal interpretations, encouraging experimentation and individual expression.

Colour, confidence and self-expression **Ages 6–16**
Children's Cancer Hospital Egypt 57357 | 2025

Facilitated colouring activities that gave children choice and space to express feelings and concerns in an encouraging, age-appropriate setting.

Approach to Art & Design Education

- Make professional studio techniques accessible through progressive demonstrations, creative experimentation and age-appropriate projects, from early sketches to finished work.
- Differentiate materials, task complexity and pacing; use brief activities, visual prompts, established routines and positive reinforcement to support participation.
- Assess individual growth through artworks, exploration and reflection. Aim to build student sketchbook portfolios and, subject to school arrangements, opportunities for exhibitions and encounters with practising artists.

Artistic Techniques & Digital Tools

Drawing & painting: Sketching, observational drawing, shading, colour theory, acrylic, gouache, watercolour and water-based inks.

Printmaking & experimental media: Relief and intaglio printmaking, screen printing, lithography, monoprint, cyanotype, water marbling, collage, mosaics and mixed media.

3D and sustainable art: Clay modelling, basic sculpture and recycled-material projects.

Digital preparation: Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Canva and Google Classroom.

Education & Professional Development

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Department of Animation and Book Art 1999
Helwan University, Egypt

Art Therapy Specialist Preparation Programme, 180 hours (Excellent) 2022
Ain Shams University, Faculty of Specific Education / Arts Centre, with collaborating training association

Applied Behaviour Analysis (ABA) training, 10 hours 2022
Training programme delivered with Ain Shams University's Faculty of Specific Education / Arts Centre

Psychological Disorders training, 10 hours 2022
Training programme delivered with Ain Shams University's Faculty of Specific Education / Arts Centre

Group Therapy with Psychodrama training, 18 hours 2022
Certificate of attendance

Psychological Counselling professional training 2023
Course-completion and distinction certificates; supporting documents available

Healing with the Arts 2024
University of Florida-authorised, non-credit online course offered via Coursera

Recognition & Professional Membership

State Grant for Artistic Dedication, Egyptian Ministry of Culture (four consecutive years). Selected exhibitions and engagements: Ahmed Shawqi Museum (2026); Mahmoud Mokhtar Museum (2024); Alexandria University Lithography Forum (2023); Bibliotheca Alexandrina (2023); Montez Gallery, Rome (2021). Member, Egyptian Art Therapy Association.

Professional references and supporting certificates available on request.